TikCal — Product Description

A social calendar for concert-going in NYC — built for a redesign handoff

1. Project Concept

TikCal solves a scattering problem. A person going to shows in New York City typically has tickets spread across Ticketmaster, SeatGeek, Dice, screenshots in Photos, forwarded emails, and text threads — while their friends' plans live in a completely different place: group chats, memory, or nowhere at all. Deciding on a night out means digging through all of that before anyone can actually decide.

TikCal's answer is to become the single surface where both halves of that problem live together: a personal calendar that ingests tickets from any source, and a social layer (friends, invite-only "crews," RSVPs, and live availability) that shows who's free and who's already going. The product thesis, in the app's own words, is **"Every source, one calendar."**

The app is explicitly scoped to NYC concert-going as its wedge use case rather than a general-purpose group calendar — the Discover feed, Smart Add parsing, and onboarding totem/venue flows are all tuned around "shows," not generic events.

2. Who It's For

Groups of friends — a "crew" — who go to concerts and shows together in New York City and want shared visibility into who's going where, without manually cross-referencing calendars or chasing RSVPs across five different group chats. The product assumes a dense, existing friend group rather than a stranger-discovery social network.

3. Core Concepts

Concept	What it means in TikCal
Event	A show/concert with date, venue, artist — added manually, via Smart Add, or pulled from Discover.
Crew	An invite-only friend group with its own color identity; events shared into a crew appear on every member's calendar.
Friend	A 1:1 follow relationship, lighter-weight than crew membership.
RSVP	A per-event response status (e.g. going / maybe / can't make it), color-coded amber/coral.
Overlap	A separate group-availability tool: participants mark free/busy blocks across a date range and daypart, and TikCal computes the best shared windows to plan around — live, multi-

	participant, with guest (non-account) join support.
Smart Add	Paste a ticket link, raw text, or a screenshot and TikCal extracts title/artist/date/venue automatically instead of manual entry.

4. Page-by-Page Walkthrough

Landing `/`

Public marketing entry point. Headline "Every source · one calendar," a three-feature grid (One calendar, Friends + crews, Smart Add), and a single CTA that routes signed-in users straight to their calendar and everyone else to sign-up. Carries the app's core SEO description.

About `/about`

Static info page stating the problem ("tickets live in a dozen apps and inboxes") and the product's answer, plus a forward-looking "what's next" note inviting source/feature requests.

Signup / Login / Forgot Password / Reset Password `/signup /login /forgot-password /reset-password`

Standard Supabase-backed auth flow. Nothing exotic — email/password account creation and recovery gating access to the rest of the app.

Welcome `post-signup`

A first-run animated moment: a spotlight beam and the TikCal wordmark light up while a disco-ball mascot rises into frame before handing off into onboarding. Purely a delight/brand beat, plays once.

Setup `/setup`

One-time profile onboarding: display name, short bio, a favorite-venue picker, and a "totem" (an icon-based personal avatar/identity chosen from a preset set) — required before the account is considered fully set up.

Dashboard (Calendar) `/calendar`

The home screen and default post-login destination. Renders every event visible to the user — personal plus everything shared via crews — in a zoomable Month/Week calendar. Plays a one-time "dance floor" intro animation on first load of a session (not on every tab switch back).

Add Show `/add`

Manual + Smart Add event entry: title, artist, date, venue (via a venue picker), notes, and an optional file upload for Smart Add's link/text/screenshot parsing. Can be deep-linked with a pre-filled date (used by the Plan page to seed an open night).

Event Detail `/event/:id`

Full event view: RSVP controls, add-to-calendar export (Google Calendar, Outlook, and .ics download), and event management (edit/delete for the owner).

Discover `/discover`

Upcoming NYC concert feed pulled from Ticketmaster, personalized against the user's connected Spotify artists so relevant shows surface first. One tap adds a discovered show straight into the user's calendar.

Friends `/friends`

Social graph management: search and add friends, send/accept friend requests, create and manage crews (including a crew color picker from a fixed palette), invite people into a crew, and accept/decline crew invites. This is the densest page in the app — it's the social backbone the calendar and Overlap features both depend on.

Plan `/plan`

A forward-looking scouting view: scans roughly six weeks ahead, flags Thursday/Friday/Saturday nights specifically ("a night out"), cross-references the user's connected Google Calendar busy/free data, and shows which of those nights are actually open — with a direct link into Add Show pre-seeded with the chosen date.

Overlap `/overlap`

Entry point for the group-availability feature: lists the user's existing overlap sessions and lets them start a new one (date range + daypart selection via a modal). Distinct from the main calendar — Overlap is about finding a window to plan around, not tracking confirmed shows.

Overlap Session `/overlap/:id`

The live collaborative grid: each participant marks their free/busy blocks (manually or by importing their TikCal calendar's busy blocks), the app computes overlap in real time across all participants via Supabase subscriptions, and surfaces "best windows" where the most people are free. Supports guest participants who join without a full account. This is the most complex screen in the product.

Profile `/profile`

Account hub: past/upcoming event history, integrations (connect/disconnect Google Calendar and Spotify, trigger a Spotify sync), and sharing utilities — a personal email-to-inbox address for forwarding ticket confirmations, and a personal calendar feed URL/token (with rotation) for subscribing externally.

Help / Contact / Privacy / Terms `/help /contact /privacy /terms`

Standard support and legal scaffolding. Help documents the two things a new user actually needs (Smart Add, crews/friends); Contact routes to a support email; Privacy/Terms are static legal pages.

5. Platform & Architecture

- **Web app:** React 18 + Vite 5 + Tailwind CSS 3.
- **Backend:** Supabase (Postgres with Row-Level Security on every public table; writes that need validation go through `SECURITY DEFINER` RPCs rather than direct table access).
- **Integrations:** Ticketmaster (Discover feed), Spotify (artist-based personalization), Google Calendar (busy/free import, calendar export).
- **Mobile:** Capacitor wrapper in progress, with native iOS and Android project shells already scaffolded in the repo, wrapping the same web app for app-store distribution.

6. Current Visual Design System ("Aurora")

The current theme is a near-black, violet/magenta "aurora" aesthetic, which replaced an earlier cyan "Wide Ice" theme. Two design rules matter most for anyone redesigning this app:

- **Color is information.** Data hues (crew colors, RSVP status, the Overlap "free/GO" state) are semantically load-bearing and are explicitly called out as off-limits for rebranding — they must survive any visual redesign, even if the chrome changes entirely.
- **Brand chrome is violet**, used consistently for the wordmark glow, primary CTAs, nav-active state, and calendar today/selection markers.

Brand / chrome

- `ink #0b0b11 (bg)`
- `ink2 #060609 (recessed)` `aurora #c04bff`
- `violet #8b5cff` `iris #5b6bff`

Semantic data hues (preserve)

- `mint — shared / "I'm in"`
- `orange — Overlap free/GO`
- `ice — legacy, crew-color only`

Plus 10 assignable crew colors and an RSVP amber/coral pair (see `src/lib/constants.js`).

Typography

- **Barlow** 800 italic — logo/wordmark
- **Syne** — headings
- **Space Grotesk** — body
- **IBM Plex Mono** — labels and data (timestamps, kickers, tags)

Surfaces

Soft rounded "HUD" panels (`HudBox`) are the default container, with an optional bracket variant for legacy HUD corner marks. Event cards use a dark card with a colored left "spine" carrying the event's crew hue. The backdrop is an aurora light-leak bloom rather than a hard sci-fi grid.

7. In-Flight & Recent Work

- **Overlap event recommendations** (Ticketmaster × Spotify) — built and deployed on a feature branch, surfacing recommended events directly inside overlap windows.
- **Mobile app (Capacitor)** — four-phase plan to wrap the web app for iOS and Android; native shells scaffolded, work ongoing.
- **Prior redesign audit** (week of 2026-07-28) — 20 plugins/dependencies audited, 5 UX bugs identified, a four-phase redesign drafted, and drag-and-drop calendar interactions shipped as a first pass.

8. Reference Material for a Redesign

- `CLAUDE.md` — design tokens, database conventions, engineering rules.
- `docs/tikcal-overlap-design.md` — Overlap's cell-state → render contract.
- `docs/tikcal-overlap-spec.md` — full Overlap feature spec.

TikCal — product description generated for design handoff. Source repo: `~/tikcal`.